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FOUNDATION TRUST

CHILD SAFEGUARDING AND PROTECTION POLICY

The Longhorn Foundation Trust (LFT) exists to transform education in Kenya and beyond by equipping underserved children with foundational literacy and numeracy skills. Our mission is to foster lifelong learning, personal growth, and meaningful societal contribution. Children are at the heart of our work. Guided by our core values -Equity, Quality, Understanding, Integrity, and Purpose (EQUIP), we recognize that safeguarding and protection are inseparable from education. This policy ensures that every child engaged in LFT programs learns in a safe, respectful, and nurturing environment, free from harm and exploitation.

Policy Objectives

All LFT programs shall prioritize the safety, dignity, and protection of every child involved in its activities. The organization is committed to establishing and enforcing clear standards of conduct for all staff, volunteers, and partners to ensure responsible and ethical engagement with children. LFT will also work to create learning environments that are safe, inclusive, and supportive, enabling children to participate and thrive without fear of harm or discrimination.

Policy Principles

1) Safe Learning Environments

Guided by its core value of equity, LFT is committed to ensuring that every child regardless of gender, ability, or socioeconomic background learns in a safe, inclusive, and supportive environment. Classrooms, libraries, and community learning centers will be regularly assessed and monitored to maintain safety standards. These measures support the organization's mission of equipping underserved children with foundational literacy and numeracy skills in spaces that are secure, respectful, and free from harm.

2) Clear Reporting and Response Mechanisms

In line with its value of integrity, LFT maintains transparent and accountable systems for reporting safeguarding concerns. Confidential reporting channels will be available to children, caregivers, staff, and partners, enabling them to raise concerns without fear of retaliation. Established response procedures ensures that all safeguarding issues are addressed promptly, reinforcing the organization's commitment to ethical responsibility and trust.

3) Code of Conduct for Staff and Partners

Rooted in the value of understanding, LFT enforces a strict code of conduct that requires all staff, volunteers, and partners to respect the dignity, rights, and individuality of every child. The code strictly prohibits exploitation, discrimination, abuse, or inappropriate relationships, ensuring that all interactions promote a safe and respectful learning environment.

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4) **Community and Caregiver Engagement**
LFT actively engages parents, caregivers, and community leaders in safeguarding efforts to strengthen the protection and well-being of children. Through awareness programs, parenting education, and adult literacy initiatives, the organization promotes shared responsibility for child safety. This collaborative approach empowers families and communities to create supportive environments where children's learning, development, and protection are reinforced both at school and at home.

Accountability & Monitoring
The Board of Trustees provides strategic oversight to ensure that the organization complies with established safeguarding standards and policies. The Management Team is responsible for implementing and monitoring safeguarding practices across all programs and operational activities. Regular audits and evaluations will be conducted to assess the effectiveness of safeguarding measures and identify areas requiring improvement. In addition, donors and stakeholders will receive transparent and periodic reports on safeguarding practices, actions taken, and outcomes achieved to promote accountability and trust.

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